



Aww that's sweet!

Youtube filmmaker Casey Neistat gets a consolation gift from his fans at Nokia. Read on to know why: <http://dgit.in/18Jv3Fb>



Congo

Samsung buys 7.4% stakes in a well-known Gorilla Glass-making firm. Business, as usual <http://dgit.in/1dhuqGk>

Agent 001

The right decision?

I'm a student in Chennai. On the commencement of the semester, I bought Micromax Doodle1. I had a budget of ₹10,000 and was confused between :

- A) Samsung Galaxy S Duos.
- B) Micromax Canvas 2.
- C) Micromax Canvas Doodle.

Because of the smaller screen and lesser specifications, I chunked Galaxy S Duos off the list and shortlisted the two Micromax phones. And finally, I chose Micromax Doodle cause it gave a quad core processor. The only real risk I thought I took was that I gave up on a better RAM.

Canvas2 gave me a 1GB RAM with a single core processing unit. CanvasDoodle gave me 512MB RAM and a quad core processor. Was this a good decision?

Also, could you in your next issue compare Micromax's flagship models with the other expensive phones with similar specifications?

Hrushikesh. V

A The Canvas Doodle is your best bet here. it has a large display and the specifications of the device are good enough to run all the apps. Yes, with 512MB of RAM, you may see some lag during multitasking but the overall performance of the Doodle is good. So yes, it was a good decision to pick up the Doodle.

In-ear headphones advice

Hello! I am in desperate need of a new earphone (in-ear only). I am not an audiophile but I am somewhat nit-picky about the audio quality. Currently I own a Philips SHE3570WT which I had to buy urgently when both my Sony MDR-EX35LP and Creative EP-630 died (unfortunately, they died long before I bought my Lumia so I have no idea how they would have sounded with my current phone). I would use it with my cell phone, Nokia Lumia 620. The Lumia has a strictly average sound quality. The bass is OK but the highs are just too harsh for my liking especially at the frequency range of 7KHz-12KHz. The same problem is with my Philips in-ear too! It has a spike in output for the same frequency

range, which destroys the listening experience, making the music even more harsh at higher volumes. So I need to keep the highs low from the equalizer. I experimented with Nokia in-ears that came with my previous phone (the ones you can get separately at ₹349). The Nokia in-ears have good bass but submerged vocals and highs. The Lumia didn't sound harsh with the Nokia in-ears, maybe due to the fact that it submerges the vocals and highs.

So, the conclusions are:

1. I need an in-ear headphone that WOULD NOT SOUND TOO HARSH when using with my phone.
2. I want good bass, tight bass for that thumping experience when I listen to Rap/Hip-hop and Rock songs. The Sony and the Creative had lesser bass than I would like (I used them with my previous phone 5800 Xpress Music)
3. Sweet highs would be great but I doubt whether I would get that quality when the output of the device itself is crappy.
4. A good soundstage is preferable
5. The in-ears SHOULD NOT HAVE any in-line mic/volume controls, just plain in-ears only for music.
6. Cable should be good enough as I always keep my headphones with me and travel in crowded buses and auto-rickshaws with them.
7. Though I don't listen to vocal music a lot but still, good vocals are sometimes needed when listening to soft Hindi songs.
8. Treble should not be overpowering. Already my phone has overpowering (and harsh) treble!

My budget this time is ₹3,000. Not many brands are available where I live. I see only Sony, Sennheiser and Skullcandy are available in Reliance Digital here. Philips and JBL Tempo can be seen sometimes. I have shortlisted Sony XB30EX and Sennheiser CX 300-II because many are saying that they have somewhat submerged vocals and highs and I think that may solve the problem of my phone having harsh higher frequencies. By reading mixed reviews online, I am really confused between the two. Please advice which of the two

would be better for use with my phone and also suggest other alternatives.

Siddhanta Biswas

A Great to see a mail from a discerning reader. You are very right about the source and it matters a lot when it comes to great audio reproduction. In our test labs the difference is very noticeable when we try playing the same test samples from our Xonar Essence One amp or the STX or the iPad and even a portable source like the HTC Radar smartphone. We usually recommend devices that have a neutral signature so that you can tweak individual preferences using a DSP Equalizer. Considering your case I'd say you stay away from SoundMagic in-ears or even something like the Meelectronics M6. For your particular situation the Creative HITZ MA 350 is a good choice and well within your budget. It does have volume controls and mic but they cause no hindrance. The cable is flat and tangle free. Another good choice – and one that is even cheaper – is the Cowon EM1. The Cowon is available in a microphone-free version as well. Both should be available via online shopping websites. As for the Sony XB30EX and Sennheiser CX 300-II we can't give you an opinion because we honestly haven't got them in for review yet. Hope to hear from you again.

For want of a GPU

I want to buy a graphics card, either 1GB or 2GB. Can you please suggest what to buy and where to buy it from? My system configuration:

Intel Core i3-2100 (3.1GHz), 4GB RAM. I want to play games like NFS Run, Mass Effect, etc.

Chidella Saijayachand

A We'll need more details before we can recommend a card.

- What PSU are you using?
- What motherboard are you using?
- What's your budget?

For a tight budget, the Nvidia GT640 should be fine (available for around ₹7,000). If you have a 450+W PSU, then the Nvidia 650Ti should be ideal. (available for ₹12,000 approx). Both cards are available on Flipkart.com and PrimeABGB.com. **A**